

Name: _____

Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION

I am learning to use nominalisation to turn verbs and adjectives into nouns, creating a more formal, precise and academic writing style.

KEY IDEA

Nominalisation turns a VERB or ADJECTIVE into a NOUN using suffixes like -tion, -ment, -ance, -ity, -ness: 'decide' → 'decision'. This creates denser, more formal language used in reports, essays and academic writing. It also allows writers to package complex ideas as noun phrases.

WARM UP — QUICK CHECK!

Nominalise (turn into a noun) each verb or adjective:

discover →

happy →

argue →

curious →

A — NOMINALISE THE VERB

Write the noun form of each verb. Add a suitable suffix (-tion, -ment, -ance, -al):

decide →

explain →

develop →

arrive →

achieve →

perform →

improve →

suggest →

B — NOMINALISE THE ADJECTIVE

Write the noun form of each adjective. Add a suitable suffix (-ity, -ness, -ance):

happy →

curious →

honest →

generous →

responsible →

significant →

patient →

clear →

C — UPGRADE THE SENTENCE

Informal: 'Scientists discovered that the medicine worked well.' Formal (nominalised): 'Scientists' discovery that the medicine was effective was significant.'

Rewrite each informal sentence using nominalisation to create a formal style:
1. 'The government decided to build new hospitals.'

2. 'She explained how the experiment worked.'

D — ACADEMIC WRITING

Write a formal paragraph (3-4 sentences) about a topic you have studied in Science or HASS. Include at least 3 nominalisations — circle each one when you have written it:

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Answer Guide (For Parent / Teacher Use)

Warm Up: discovery, happiness, argument, curiosity.

A: decision, explanation, development, arrival, achievement, performance, improvement, suggestion.

B: happiness, curiosity, honesty, generosity, responsibility, significance, patience, clarity.

C1: Accept: 'The government's decision to build new hospitals was welcomed.' or similar.

C2: Accept: 'Her explanation of how the experiment worked was clear.' or similar.

D: Accept any formal 3-4 sentence paragraph containing at least 3 correctly identified nominalisations.

High Five! You are a Language Champion! ✓
Colour a star for each section you completed successfully:



EXTENSION / CHALLENGE

Find 3 examples of nominalisation in a news report or textbook. For each, identify the original verb or adjective and explain why the author chose the nominalised noun form — what does it add to the writing?

PARENT TIP

Compare informal speech with formal writing: 'How would you say this casually to a friend? How would a scientist or newsreader say the same thing more formally?' Discuss the difference.

TEACHER TIP

Introduce nominalisation as a key feature of academic and persuasive writing. Use before/ after sentence comparisons to show the shift in formality, density and tone.

STUDENT REFLECTION

☐ I can identify nominalisation in texts I read

☐ I can nominalise verbs and adjectives into nouns using appropriate suffixes

☐ I can use nominalisation to write in a more formal and academic style